



MOBILE MADNESS

You have to try these games out on your smartphone!

Team Skoar!

Beatstar

One look on the screenshots and you will feel like this is just another Piano Tiles rip off. Now, don't get us wrong, some elements do resemble Piano Tiles but the way the app has been presented is very different. Beatstar is a rhythm game developed by Space Ape studios. The main motive of the game is to complete a given song without missing a single note.



The songs are a whole different story here. We don't know how but the developer managed to get all of the famous Pop, Hip-Hop and EDM songs in the app without getting copyright striked to hell and back by the legal teams of the respective owners of the songs. Furthermore, it's not even that the songs are pitch shifted or are covers of the original song, they ARE the original song.

Moving on, to actually play the game, you will have to tap the tiles coming towards you to the beat of the song. During almost 2-3 hours of playtime of this game, we found that the tiles were synced to the vocals of the song instead of being

synced to the beat of the song but we'll let it pass. Also, you cannot just randomly tap the tiles to the beat. They need to be right in the "Perfect" window.

You are awarded points and combos based on whether you hit the notes early, late or just on time. It is important to note here that you will only be able to hold a combo if you get "Perfect" consecutively. If you tap late or early then the combo will break and you'll have to rebuild it all over again.

One interesting mechanic that we found in this game is the difficulty progression through the level. In one song itself, the difficulty will increase throughout the song. With the scroll speed, the positioning of notes and the patterns consecutively getting harder. The reason why we found this mechanic a bit different from other games is that almost all scroll based rhythm games will increase the scroll speed in order to increase the difficulty but

very few will also change the patterns and make them harder too.

Coming to the things that we didn't like about the game. First of all, almost all the music in the game is locked behind an intense paywall. You see, the game doesn't just give you all the songs when you start out. You have to unlock them. In order to unlock them, you either have to get them through loot boxes (which will make you wait for x amount of time before getting unlocked) or you have to buy them using the game's ingame currency which in turn can be bought with real life money. Also,

you may face a hard limit to how much you can play in a single sitting as if all the slots for the loot boxes are full, you will have to wait for one of them to get unlocked and free up the slot. Only then will you be able to continue playing the game.

All in all, when we first started playing this game, we were really hooked to it since it offered really fluid animations, good graphics and some pretty decent songs too. But slowly, as we discovered the aggressive paywalls around the game, it started becoming a bit undesirable to play it. But still, if you just want to try out a rhythm game on your phone which is not Piano Tiles, you should give this one a spin!

Murders on Budapest

Murders on Budapest is a novel based murder mystery in a text-based or Visual Novel format. Something which we liked about the game is that it is totally based on your choices. There's plenty of content, and it has a lot of twists, turns and surprises.

Coming to the story-line of the game, one thing we would like to say right away is that this game has the best mystery story ever. The fact that the story forward depends entirely on the decisions you make is amazing. A gist of the story is that there is a guy named Doyle who goes hiking and gets lost in the mountains during a storm. He later finds a group of people who are lost too. Walking a little further, they see a grand estate and take shelter there. When the group tries to leave the place, one of them turns up dead, now you have to find out

